

THE PROBLEM, IN YOUR WORDS

Short-notice cancellations leave chairs empty, and filling them is a manual chase.

Today you or Carla spot the cancellation in Square, look through the Google Sheet for clients who might fit, text them from the salon phone, and keep checking for replies in between everything else.

Chasing replies by hand

"We have to keep checking replies and move down the list manually, and sometimes the appointment stays empty."

Two clients, one Saturday haircut

"Last month two clients expected the same Saturday haircut after both replied yes to a group text. Different staff members had answered them, so one client left angry."

The next person never gets asked

"We lose track of who was contacted and who declined, and sometimes nobody gets to the next person. Then the chair sits empty even though someone might have taken it."

8–12 cancellations inside 48 hours
in a typical week

Each one that isn't refilled is an empty chair, and an empty chair "affects both the salon and the stylist because they're paid on commission."

HOW THE PROTOTYPE WORKS

Add the opening once. It works the waitlist for you.

It follows the rule you chose: "one at a time in waitlist order feels fairer and avoids competing acceptances."

1 Add the opening

You or Carla enter the service, stylist, date and time. It takes a few seconds, and Square stays your real calendar.

2 It finds who fits

Clients who want that service, are free at that time, and either don't mind which stylist or asked for this one. Whoever joined the waitlist first goes first. Anyone who opted out of texts is never contacted.

3 One client gets a text

It shows the service, stylist, date and time, and asks them to **Reply YES or NO**. Only one client holds the offer at a time.

4 It waits, then moves on by itself

A same-day offer is held for 15 minutes (60 minutes for later dates). After a NO, or no reply in time, the next client gets the text.

5 Booked, and everyone is told

On a YES, the client gets a confirmation, the front desk gets a note to add it to Square, and anyone whose time ran out hears that it has been filled.

The screenshot displays the 'JUNIPER SALON Last-minute openings' interface. At the top, a 'New opening' form allows users to select a service (e.g., Haircut), stylist (e.g., Ana), date (e.g., 10/07/2026), and time (e.g., 02:00 PM). A 'Start filling this opening' button is present. Below this, a list of openings is shown, including 'Color with Ben' and 'Blowout with Ben'. Each entry includes details like the time, duration, and a 'What happened' section. For 'Color with Ben', it shows a list of clients (Grace Kim, Omar Haddad) and their status (e.g., 'Couldn't reach', 'Has the offer - 46 min left'). A 'Cancel opening' button is visible. On the right, a 'Client phones (simulated texts)' section shows a list of clients (Maya, Jordan, Lucy, Sofia, Dev, Grace, Omar, Nina) and a simulated text conversation with Omar Haddad. The text conversation includes a message from Juniper Salon and a response from Omar Haddad. A 'Send' button is at the bottom of the text conversation.

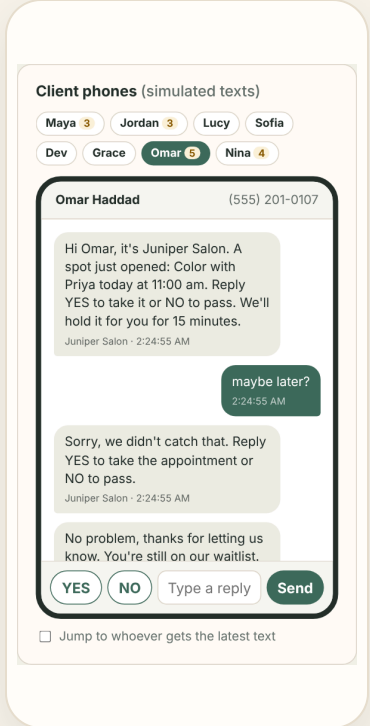
The staff board, at a glance: who has the offer and how long they have left, who declined, timed out or couldn't be reached, who's next, and whether the opening is filled, cancelled or unfilled.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Built so nothing slips through the cracks.

Every problem is either handled automatically or shown to staff right away. Temporal, the system underneath, makes sure no opening gets lost or forgotten along the way.

If this happens	What the prototype does	What you told us
Two clients want the same opening	Only one client holds the offer at a time, so two people can never both be booked into it.	<i>"two clients expected the same Saturday haircut"</i>
A YES arrives after their time ran out	They get a polite text saying it's no longer available and they're still on the waitlist.	<i>"We have to tell them it's gone, which is awkward."</i>
A text doesn't go through	It's retried automatically. If it still fails, that client is skipped and staff are told to check the number.	<i>"a message not reaching someone"</i>
A reply is unclear, like maybe later?	The client is asked to answer YES or NO, and staff see a flag with one-click Mark yes and Mark no buttons.	<i>"Replies can also be unclear"</i>
Nobody takes the opening	It's marked unfilled and staff are told, so you can step in yourselves.	<i>"we need to know when the process stops"</i>
You need to call it off	Staff can cancel an opening at any time, and whoever holds the offer is told.	<i>"cancel it if the client changes their mind"</i>
The computer running it restarts	Every opening picks up exactly where it was, countdown included.	<i>"an opening quietly stalling"</i>



A client's phone: the offer, then a clear answer either way.

REAL VS. SIMULATED

What's real in this prototype, and what isn't yet.

How it decides who to text, when to move on and what to tell people is real and working. Anything that would reach real clients or your real records is simulated for now.

Working in the prototype

- ✓ Creating an opening in a few seconds, and cancelling it at any time
- ✓ Matching clients by service, time and stylist, in waitlist order, and never texting anyone who opted out
- ✓ One offer at a time, the 15- and 60-minute holds, and moving on by itself after a NO or no reply
- ✓ Confirmations, front-desk notes, letting others know it's filled, and polite replies to a late YES
- ✓ Retrying failed texts, flagging unclear replies, and telling staff when an opening goes unfilled
- ✓ Picking up exactly where it was if the computer restarts
- ✓ The staff board, plus on-screen client phones so you can play the client

Simulated or left out, for now

- **Texts** appear on simulated phones on screen. No real texting service is connected yet.
- **The waitlist** is sample data with made-up names and 555 numbers, not your Google Sheet.
- **Square** isn't connected, as you chose: "We don't need this to update Square; staff handle the real calendar."
- **The clock** runs fast for demos: 1 minute = 1 second, so a 15-minute hold lasts 15 seconds.
- **Not built yet:** staff logins, running on more than one computer, a quiet-hours rule (you have "no formal rule" yet), and clients joining the waitlist from the app.

PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Next step: a two-week pilot at Juniper.

Real clients, the salon's own number and your own waitlist, so we can see whether it fills more chairs and saves you time.

The pilot

- 1 Connect a real texting service to the salon's phone number.
- 2 Import your Google Sheet waitlist.
- 3 Use it for every cancellation inside 48 hours.
- 4 Carla watches the board instead of the phone.

Two decisions for you first

Hold time for later openings

How long a client gets to answer when the opening isn't same-day. We used 60 minutes.

Quiet hours

When texts should never go out, for example before 9am or after 8pm.

How we'll measure it

Openings filled

out of your 8–12 short-notice cancellations a week

Time spent chasing replies

compared with today

Double bookings

target: zero

SUCCESS, IN YOUR WORDS

"We'd spend much less time chasing replies, and Carla would know when the process had stopped or failed."